Independence, is more than ever the clearly dominant power in the wider subcontinent (see Figure 1.1). Even though Pakistan alone still forces India to prepare for the combined threats of nuclear weapons (Pakistan went nuclear in 1998), conventional warfare (The Kargil War in 1999), insurgency (Jammu and Kashmir), and terrorism (the 2008 Mumbai attacks), the power gap between India and Pakistan is widening to India's advantage. India's GDP was four times larger than that of Pakistan in the year 2000, but this gap had increased to ten times the size of Pakistan's GDP in 2015 and is estimated to increase further in the next few years. India's 2018 military expenditure was six times the size of Pakistan's.[2]

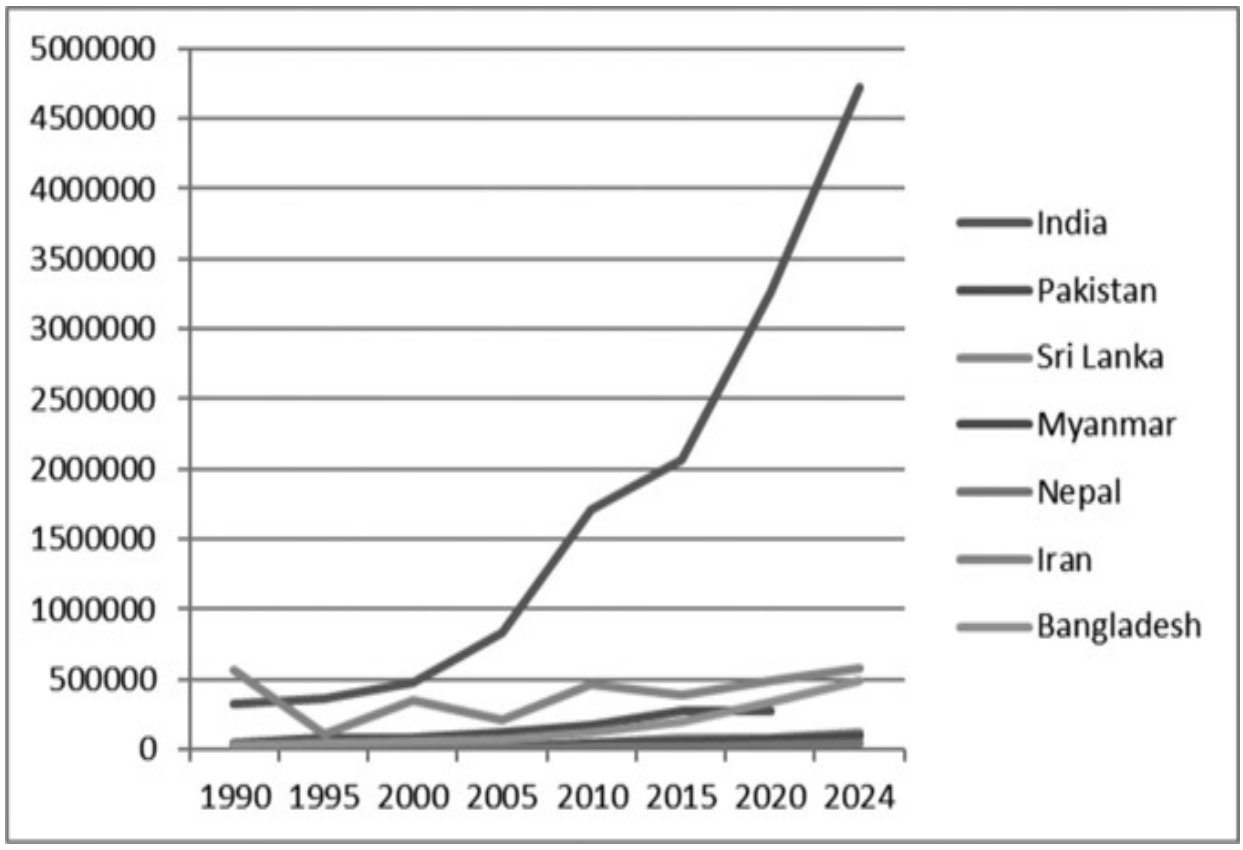


FIGURE 1.1 India and economic growth in South Asia (GDP in USD millions)
Source: IMF (2019). The figures are GDP, in USD millions, current prices. Estimates for Pakistan for 2020 are 2019 figures. Estimates for 2024 are not available.